

3.2 Dimensions: width and height

Two very important properties that can be declared for any element are its width and height. Both properties are essential for setting specific heights and widths of elements. Consider that an element's width will increase to fit its container, while its height will increase to encompass its content, you will start to realise before long that, in some situations, a certain amount of control is missing. By applying width and/or height rules, you can regain this control.

Values can be given as a length, percentage, or auto. Note that all of these values can be influenced adversely by other rules within the style sheet, and also by the HTML elements they might contain. For example, the resulting display can be affected by a number of values from margin, padding, border, or child elements.

3.3 Margin

The margin property is used to declare the margin between an HTML element and its neighbours. The margin can be set for the top, left, right, and bottom of the given element. Note that margin values are not inherited from parent elements. There are three choices of values for the margin property, which are length, percentage, or auto. Note that if the value is 0, you do not need to add px. Consider the following CSS for a container div. Note that it has a fixed width of 300px and no margin properties.



The container is always starts from the left of the page by default

```
/* Basic container */
#container {
width:300px;
border: 1px solid #000;
padding: 20px;
background: #CCC;
}
```

By applying margin properties to each side of the container, the display can be significantly altered: